

# Technical documentation

---

**Welcome to the technical documentation wiki of the Digital Research Alliance of Canada (the Alliance).** This is the primary source for users with questions on equipment and services of the Alliance.

The focus here is on national services and systems. For documentation on services and systems managed by our regional partners, please use the links provided below.

This wiki is a constant work-in-progress and some links might take you to pages which do not yet have content; such pages display **like this**. Our staff works constantly to improve and expand the available documentation; note however that any of our users is free to add new material and edit existing content.

## Systems and services

### Systems

- [2025 infrastructure renewal](#)
- **General-purpose clusters**, for CPU or GPU jobs:
  - [Fir](#), [Nibi](#), [Narval](#), [Rorqual](#)
- [Trillium](#), a cluster designed for large parallel jobs
- GPU clusters which are part of the Pan-Canadian AI Compute Environment (PAICE)
  - [Killarney](#), [tamIA](#), [Vulcan](#)
- Legacy clusters that are at the end of their life or retired:
  - [Béluga](#), [Cedar](#), [Graham](#), [Niagara](#)

### Services

- [Available software](#)
- **Cloud** computing service
- [Database servers](#)
- [Globus](#) file transfer service

## How-to guides

### ▪ [Getting started](#)

- [Trillium Quick Start Guide](#)
- [Cloud Quick Start Guide](#)
- [SSH](#) - How to connect to our compute clusters
- [Linux introduction](#)

### ▪ [Storage and file management](#)

- [Transferring data](#)
- [Scratch purging policy](#)

### ▪ [Best practices for data migration](#)

### ▪ [Using modules and Standard software environments](#) to access software

### ▪ [Running jobs](#)

- [Installing software yourself](#)
- [Programming guide](#)
- [Self-paced courses](#)
- [Visualization](#)
- How to get [technical support](#)

- [Nextcloud](#) cloud storage service
- **Research Data Management** (<https://alliancecan.ca/en/services/research-data-management>)
- **Research Software** (<https://alliancecan.ca/en/services/research-software>)
- [Quantum computing services](#)

The **Service status page** (<https://status.alliancecan.ca/>) describes current and planned outages of clusters and services. FAQ: **Frequently Asked Questions**

### Discipline guides

- [AI and Machine Learning](#)
- [Bioinformatics](#)
- [Biomolecular simulation](#)
- [Computational chemistry](#)
- [Computational fluid dynamics \(CFD\)](#)
- [Geographic information systems \(GIS\)](#)
- [Humanities and Social Sciences](#)
- [Research Data Management](#)
- [Subatomic physics](#)

### Regional partners and services

- [Western training](https://training.westernstdri.ca/) (<https://training.westernstdri.ca/>)
  - [UALberta training](https://www.ualberta.ca/information-services-and-technology/research-computing/bootcamps.html) (<https://www.ualberta.ca/information-services-and-technology/research-computing/bootcamps.html>)
- [SHARCNET](https://sharcnet.ca) (<https://sharcnet.ca>)
- [SciNet](https://docs.scinet.utoronto.ca/index.php/Main_Page) ([https://docs.scinet.utoronto.ca/index.php/Main\\_Page](https://docs.scinet.utoronto.ca/index.php/Main_Page))
- [Centre for Advanced Computing](http://cac.queensu.ca/wiki) (<http://cac.queensu.ca/wiki>)
- [Calcul Québec](https://www.calculquebec.ca/) (<https://www.calculquebec.ca/>)
- [ACENET](http://www.ace-net.ca/wiki/) (<http://www.ace-net.ca/wiki/>)

---

Retrieved from "[https://docs.alliancecan.ca/mediawiki/index.php?title=Technical\\_documentation&oldid=189407](https://docs.alliancecan.ca/mediawiki/index.php?title=Technical_documentation&oldid=189407)"

---

This page was last edited on 5 September 2025, at 13:10.